

Gaps. Breakout day gaps don't help or hurt performance much. Notice that the gap size in bull markets is almost twice the size of bear market gaps. *Hmm.* That's a surprise.

I measured the median gap size (19 cents in bull markets and 21 cents in bear markets) and used those as the difference between tall and short gaps. I found that in bull markets, gaps taller than the median saw price drop an average of 19% after the breakout. Short gaps lost just 16%.

In bear markets, the results were 25% decline for tall gaps and 21% decline for short gaps.

[Table 6.5](#) shows size statistics for the big M.

Height. We see that regardless of the market condition (bull or bear), tall patterns outperform short ones, but not by much. To compute this, measure the height of the pattern from the highest peak to the lowest valley between the two peaks and divide the result by the price of the lowest valley. If the result is larger than the percentage shown in the table, then you have a tall big M.

Width. Width doesn't offer any helpful performance improvement, although narrow patterns' performance is slightly better (but probably statistically insignificant). Measure the width of the pattern from peak to peak and compare it to the 26-day median. If the result exceeds the median, then you have a wide pattern.